Adnan Aidan Taha

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Education

McGill University **Jun. 2029**

Joint Honours B.Sc. in Computer Science & Statistics *Montreal, Canada*

- AI Safety Fundamentals Fellow (associated with MIT's AI Alignment club)
- **Awards:** UWaterloo President's Scholarship of Distinction (SWE admit, declined); top 25% nationally, CCC Junior '25

Experience

Harvard MADSys Lab (SEAS) **Sep. 2026 – present**

Research Assistant *Remote*

- Collaborating with a multilingual team across **Harvard SEAS, Harvard Kennedy School, and Kempner Institute, Harvard University** to evaluate sovereign LLMs, targeting a submission to **ICML/NeurIPS**.
- Contributing to **LLM evaluation** and bias analysis, examining how model performance and bias is impacted by language across French, Arabic and English, among others.

Horizon Omega **Fall 2025 – present**

Core Member, AI Safety Montreal *Montreal, Canada*

- Authored the starter codebase used by **15+ teams** at our inaugural hackathon, introducing participants to the libraries that they will use (Control Tower and inspect_ai).
- Organized **reading groups** held on AI safety topics that vary from papers to policy drafts.

Dept. of Biomedical Engineering, University of Basel **Jul. 2024 – Apr. 2025**

Research Assistant *Remote*

- Trained and validated **U-Net** models for biomedical image segmentation, running grid search over learning rate and epoch count to optimize performance.

Holopin **Oct. 2022 – Nov. 2023**

Software Developer & Integrations Lead *Contract, Remote*

- Developed key integrations with GitHub, Slack, and Discord using **TypeScript** and **Node.js** from scratch for major potential clients such as **Cloudflare** or **Hacktoberfest**, and Salesforce, serving **50,000 users** in their first month.
- Authored technical documentation and articles consulted by **500+ organizations** using Holopin's platform.
- Contributed to open source projects, notably LLaMA.cpp with **120,000 GitHub stars** by resolving GitHub issues.

Projects

METR Reward-Hacking Challenge **Mar. 2025**

Ranked top 4 globally, responsibly disclosed a platform security issue

McGill Course Assistant & Graph [GitHub] [Live] **May 2026 – present**

HTML/CSS, JavaScript, Cohere API, Cloudflare Workers, Vectorize & D1, GitHub Pages

- Created a **RAG pipeline** on Cohere Embed → Vector DB → Rerank → Command A+ (high-recall retrieval, query-specific reranking, grounded generation), run through Cloudflare's **AI Gateway** for caching & rate-limiting.
- Paired it with an interactive force-directed prerequisite graph of **5,800 nodes** using a Barnes-Hut quadtree for a **109x speedup**.

BrébeufHx **Aug. 2024 – May 2026**

Co-President

- Led a **150+ participant** hackathon, synchronizing **20+ organizers**, and secured **over $12,000** in sponsorship value.

Skills

Base skills: Python, TypeScript/JavaScript (← advanced), HTML/CSS (← intermediate), Java, SQL, GitHub, Cloudflare, Firebase

Frameworks: Next.js, React (← intermediate), TensorFlow, PyTorch, Linux, CI/CD (← intermediate), Control Tower, Inspect AI (← beginner)